

Dotfiles & config homes

Names that start with a dot are usually hidden from a plain list

Hidden names and home config

- A plain list shows only visible names
- Add all-files mode and the dots appear
- Home is full of them
- Projects add their own, especially the git directory and ignore rules
- Listing with all-files is the first habit; editing comes later

Browser lab

Digital Design and Verification Platform

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INTERACTIVE TOOL

Dotfiles & config homes

See why `ls` hides names starting with `.`, where shell/Git configs live under `~`, and how project `.gitignore` keeps build junk out.

Starter example: You are in `/home/lab`. Run `ls` (few names) then `ls -a` (dotfiles appear). Open `.bashrc`, then `cd chip` and inspect `.gitignore`.

Load starter example

Challenges 0 / 22 cleared

Quiz: hidden: Names hidden from plain `ls` start with? Answer: .

Answer

Show hintCheckNextIdle

Quiz: hiddenQuiz: show allRun lsRun ls -aCount home dotscat .bashrcbashrc aliasQuiz: tilde

cd chipProject ls -acat .gitignoreIgnore buildKeep rtlIgnore vcdQuiz: .gitXDG config

Open .gitconfigQuiz: globeditorconfigcd ~Plain hidesQuiz: purpose

Lab terminal

pwd /home/lab

Starter: try `ls` then `ls -a` – then `cat .bashrc` and `cd chip`

Directory listing

ls (dotfiles hidden)

.name = hidden from plain ls

.bashrc.config/.gitconfig.profile

chip/notes.txt

Dotfiles lab

Real shell practice

```
wsl - module08-dotfiles-lab/examples/dotfiles

# Track A - real Unix
# real shell session (Track A)

$ ls
README.md
visible.txt

$ ls -a
.
..
.gitignore
.hidden_dir
.hidden_file
.sample_rc
README.md
visible.txt

$ ls -la
total 4
drwxrwxrwx 1 yongfu yongfu 4096 Jul 18 16:34 .
drwxrwxrwx 1 yongfu yongfu 4096 Jul 20 00:49 ..
-rwxrwxrwx 1 yongfu yongfu  67 Jul 18 16:34 .gitignore
drwxrwxrwx 1 yongfu yongfu 4096 Jul 18 16:34 .hidden_dir
-rwxrwxrwx 1 yongfu yongfu  57 Jul 18 16:34 .hidden_file
-rwxrwxrwx 1 yongfu yongfu  71 Jul 18 16:34 .sample_rc
-rwxrwxrwx 1 yongfu yongfu 2314 Jul 18 16:34 README.md
-rwxrwxrwx 1 yongfu yongfu  58 Jul 18 16:34 visible.txt

$ cat .hidden_file
This file name starts with a dot. Use "ls -a" to see it.

$ cat .sample_rc
# Example dotfile for Module 2. Use: cat .sample_rc or less .sample_rc

$ ls -a ~ | head -12
.
..
.EasyOCR
.bash_aliases
.bash_history
.bash_logout
.bashrc
.cache
.config
.cursor
.cursor-server
.git-credentials
```

Real shell practice — try these

```
# ls — plain list; dot-names stay hidden  
ls
```

```
# ls -a — show all names, including those starting with a dot  
ls -a
```

```
# ls -la — long listing that includes hidden names  
ls -la
```

```
# cat .hidden_file — read a hidden file (safe inspect)  
cat .hidden_file
```

```
# cat .sample_rc — read an example config-style dotfile  
cat .sample_rc
```

```
# ls -a ~ | head -12 — peek at real home dotfiles (read-only)
```

Pitfalls to watch

- Do not edit bashrc or profile until you understand the change, a typo can break new shells
- Prefer read tools first: cat or less
- Remember that star globs often skip leading-dot names unless you ask for them
- And remember

Your turn

- Complete the checklist for at least one track, preferably both
- In the browser, finish a few challenges after the starter
- On the real shell, practice plain list versus list-all
- When you are ready, take the short quiz, then continue to process list and signals